5 frameworks in 2018.

~20 in 2026.

The compliance footprint a multinational carries today is roughly four times what it was eight years ago. The vendor-controlled audit substrate underneath each new regulation has not changed in twenty.

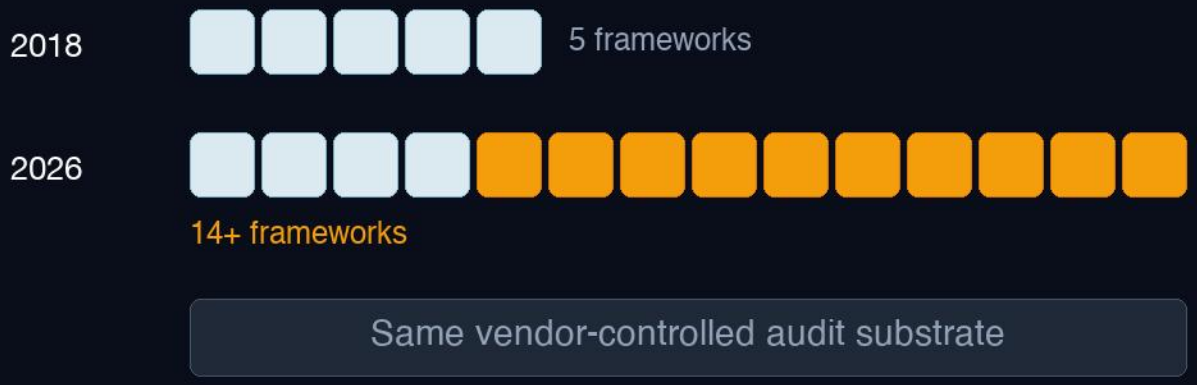
SARAH RUSHTON
COO & Co-Founder, Arkova

SWIPE >

THE GROWTH

Five years.
Three new framework families.

NIST AI RMF · EU AI Act · DORA · SEC cyber disclosure · 19 US state privacy laws · LGPD · DPDP · PDPA · POPIA · APP



Each new regulation lands on the same primitives.

Why the substrate is broken.

1 **LOCK-IN**
When evidence lives inside a vendor's system, leaving the vendor breaks the audit chain. Old timestamps may not survive the round-trip.

2 **MIGRATION**
Internal system migrations create the same problem without changing vendors. Every transition quietly degrades chain-of-custody.

3 **SELF-ATTESTATION**
The vendor stores, exports, and timestamps its own evidence. Auditors accept this because there is no commonly available alternative.

GRC platforms aggregate evidence.

Vanta · Drata · Secureframe · Workiva

They do not produce evidence that can be verified independently of the system that stored it.

Aggregation is necessary. It is not sufficient. An auditor examining a vendor log has no way to verify log entries haven't been modified. They are trusting the system and the operator.

"You cannot solve a verification problem by adding more frameworks. You solve it by fixing what evidence actually means."

SARAH RUSHTON
COO & Co-Founder, Arkova

Read the full piece.
arkova.ai/research/state-of-compliance-2026